

Maritime Security

Stowaways

Exercise 1

Stowaways – Definition & History

A stowaway is someone who **secretes** him/herself in a ship without the **consent** of the shipowner or the **person in charge**, and who is on board once the ship has **left port**.

Stowaways have existed ever since international shipping began, but they have become a **growing** problem.

In recent years, more and more people are leaving their home countries **in pursuit of** a better life with greater economic chances, or to flee war, discrimination or other conflict.

In desperation, and **lacking** funds to travel, an increasing number have resorted to stowing away aboard ship, often in the poorer countries of Africa and Asia, to seek a better life abroad.

Exercise 2

secretes – hides

consent – permission

person in charge – captain

left port – departed

a growing – an increasing

in pursuit of – to look for

lacking – without

Exercise 3

Stowaways - preventive measures

According to the **IMO**, the following preventive measures, which include provision of operational and security arrangements to prevent persons attempting to **stow away** on board ships from gaining access to port installations and to ships, should be observed.

Recommended practices for ships include the following **minimum** security arrangements:

- all doors, **hatches** and means of **access** to **holds** or stores, which are not used during the ship's stay in **port** should be **locked**;
- **access points** to the ship should be kept to a minimum and be adequately **secured**;
- areas **seaward** of the ship should be adequately secured;
- adequate **deck watch** should be kept;
- **boardings** and **disembarkations** should, where possible, be **tallied** by the ships crew or, after agreement with the shipmaster, by others;
- **adequate** means of **communication** should be maintained; and
- at night, adequate **lighting** should be **maintained** both inside and along the **hull**.

Exercise 4

TRUE FALSE

TRUE TRUE

FALSE FALSE

TRUE FALSE

TRUE FALSE

Exercise 5

How should stowaways be treated?

Stowaways create problems for a crew, but they are not **criminals** and should have their basic **human rights** respected and receive **fair treatment** while on board.

If you find a stowaway, you should:

- Check their state of **health**
- Find out their **identity** and the **reasons** they are on board
- Arrange **food** and **lodging**
- Explain **emergency** procedures and issue them with a **lifejacket** and **lifeboat** place
- Inform the ship's **owner** or **agent**
- Expect the **master** to prepare a signed **statement** containing all **information** relating to the stowaway, to be given to the **authority** where the stowaway is **delivered**

A stowaway should not be **arrested** or **detained** (although the master has the right to maintain discipline on board), and should not be forced to work.